

HAMILTON DEPRESSION QUESTIONNAIRE

Simple Patient-Friendly Version

Patient details Name: _____ Age: _____ Date: _____

MARKING / SCORING SCHEME

For each question, tick **ONE** option. Record the number shown beside your selected option as the score for that question. Add all item scores to obtain the total score.

Overall score guide: 0–7 = Normal / clinical remission; 8–13 = Mild depression; 14–18 = Moderate depression; 19–22 = Severe depression; ≥23 = Very severe depression.

Source note: The supplied HDRS source specifically states that 0–7 is generally within the normal range (or clinical remission) and that a score of 20 or higher is usually at least moderate severity. The other cut-offs in this guide are included as a practical scoring guide and are not stated in the supplied file.

Instructions: Think about how you have felt during the **past week**. For each question, tick ✓ only one answer that describes you best.

1. Feeling Sad

- 0 – I have not felt this way.
- 1 – I feel this way only when someone asks me.
- 2 – I often tell others that I feel sad or hopeless.
- 3 – My sadness is clearly visible to others, or I cry easily.
- 4 – I feel sad, hopeless, helpless, or worthless almost all the time.

Score: _____

2. Feeling Guilty

- 0 – No.
- 1 – Sometimes I feel I have disappointed others.
- 2 – I often think about my mistakes and feel guilty.
- 3 – I feel that my problems are a punishment for something I did.
- 4 – I have very strong or unusual feelings of guilt, such as hearing voices blaming me.

Score: _____

3. Thoughts About Death or Suicide

- 0 – No.
- 1 – Sometimes I feel that life is not worth living.
- 2 – I have wished I were dead or thought about dying.
- 3 – I have thought about or planned suicide.
- 4 – I have tried to end my life.

Score: _____

4. Trouble Falling Asleep

- 0 – I fall asleep normally.
- 1 – Sometimes it takes me more than 30 minutes to fall asleep.
- 2 – I have trouble falling asleep almost every night.

Score: _____

5. Waking During the Night

- 0 – No, I sleep normally.
- 1 – My sleep is sometimes restless or disturbed.
- 2 – I wake up during the night and have difficulty staying asleep.

Score: _____

6. Waking Too Early

- 0 – No.
- 1 – I wake early but can go back to sleep.
- 2 – I wake early and cannot go back to sleep.

Score: _____

7. Work and Daily Activities

- 0 – I do my usual activities normally.
- 1 – I feel tired or weak while doing them.
- 2 – I have lost interest and have to force myself to do things.
- 3 – I do much less than usual or my work has become slower.
- 4 – I have stopped most of my usual activities because of how I feel.

Score: _____

8. Slow Thinking or Movement

- 0 – No, I feel normal.
- 1 – I feel slightly slower.
- 2 – I clearly feel that my thinking, speech, or movements are slow.
- 3 – I am so slow that talking or doing things is difficult.
- 4 – I can hardly speak or move.

Score: _____

9. Restlessness

- 0 – No.
- 1 – I feel a little restless or fidgety.
- 2 – I often move my hands, hair, or body because I feel restless.
- 3 – I find it difficult to sit still.
- 4 – I have severe restlessness, such as repeatedly biting nails/lips or pulling hair.

Score: _____

10. Worry and Anxiety

- 0 – I have not felt unusually worried or anxious.
- 1 – I sometimes feel tense, worried, or irritable.
- 2 – I worry a lot, even about small things.
- 3 – My anxiety is clearly noticeable to others.
- 4 – I often feel strong fear or anxiety without needing someone to ask me.

Score: _____

11. Physical Signs of Anxiety

- 0 – No physical symptoms.
- 1 – Mild symptoms.
- 2 – Moderate symptoms.
- 3 – Severe symptoms.
- 4 – Symptoms are so severe that they interfere with my daily life.

Score: _____

12. Appetite and Stomach Problems

- 0 – My appetite is normal.
- 1 – My appetite is lower than usual, but I can eat normally.
- 2 – I have difficulty eating or need encouragement to eat, or I have significant stomach/bowel problems.

Score: _____

13. Body Aches and Low Energy

- 0 – No.
- 1 – Mild tiredness, aches, or low energy.
- 2 – A clear or significant physical problem.

Score: _____

14. Sexual or Menstrual Changes

- 0 – No change.
- 1 – Mild change.
- 2 – Severe change.

Score: _____

15. Worry About Health

- 0 – I am not unusually worried about my health.
- 1 – I often notice or think about physical symptoms.
- 2 – I spend a lot of time worrying about my health.
- 3 – I frequently ask for help or reassurance about my health.
- 4 – I strongly believe I have a serious illness even when others reassure me.

Score: _____

16. Weight Loss

- 0 – No weight loss.
- 1 – I think I may have lost some weight.
- 2 – I am sure I have lost weight.
- 3 – I am not sure / this cannot be assessed.

Score: _____

17. Understanding Your Condition

- 0 – Yes, I understand that I am depressed or emotionally unwell.
- 1 – I know I am not feeling well, but I think it is mainly because of things like food, weather, overwork, illness, or needing rest.
- 2 – I do not think that I have a health or emotional problem.

Score: _____

TOTAL SCORE: _____ / 52

For professional use: _____ Date: _____

Important: This is a simplified patient-friendly presentation of the 17-item Hamilton Depression Rating Scale (HDRS-17). The original HDRS is clinician-rated and intended to be completed following a structured interview. This patient form should not be assumed to be a validated self-report version of the HDRS.